# 2 John

*Key Notes, Cross-References, and Messianic Connections (WEB)*

Thirteen verses. One sheet of papyrus.

From the elder, to the chosen lady and her children.

Two words run through the whole letter: truth, five times, and love.

Some of your children are walking in truth, and it makes the old man glad.

Then a commandment that is not new, that we love one another.

And then he tells you what love is. This is love: that we walk according to His commandments.

Then a warning. Deceivers have gone out into the world who will not confess that Yahshua the Messiah came in the flesh.

Do not lose what you have worked for.

Do not open your door to the man who brings another teaching.

And then he stops writing. I have a lot more to say, but not with paper and ink.

I want to come and speak face to face, so that our joy may be full.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

# 2 JOHN - Truth and Love, a Commandment From the Beginning, and a Door Kept Shut

## Key Notes

- “The elder” is all he calls himself. Early tradition says it is the apostle John, by then an old man. The language is so close to John’s Gospel and first letter that most readers hear the same voice (2 John 1:1, 3 John 1:1).
- “The chosen lady and her children” may be a woman and her family, or a way of addressing an assembly and its members. The closing greeting from the children of your chosen sister suggests a sister congregation (2 John 1:1, 1:13).
- Truth appears five times in the first four verses. Love appears four times in the letter. John will not let you have either one without the other (2 John 1:1-6).
- “For the truth’s sake, which remains in us, and it will be with us forever.” Truth is not only something you hold. It is something that remains in you (2 John 1:2, Psalm 117:2).
- “Grace, mercy, and peace will be with us.” Not a wish but a promise: will be. The same three gifts the priestly blessing asks Yahweh to give - be gracious to you, and give you peace (2 John 1:3, Numbers 6:24-26).
- “The Son of the Father” - only here in the New Testament is He called by exactly that phrase. Proverbs asks what is His name, and what is His son’s name? (2 John 1:3, Proverbs 30:4).
- “I have found some of your children walking in truth.” Some. Not all. He rejoices in the ones who are, without pretending about the others (2 John 1:4).
- “Even as we have been commanded by the Father.” Walking in truth is a commandment, not a mood (2 John 1:4).
- “Not as though I wrote to you a new commandment, but that which we had from the beginning.” Love one another is as old as Leviticus 19: love your neighbor as yourself (2 John 1:5, Leviticus 19:18).
- “This is love, that we should walk according to his commandments.” John defines love by obedience, just as Moses did: love Yahweh your God and keep His commandments. Love is not set against the commandments. It walks in them (2 John 1:6, Deuteronomy 11:1).
- “Many deceivers have gone out into the world.” Gone out - they had been inside. False teaching usually starts within (2 John 1:7, 1 John 2:19).
- “Those who don’t confess that Jesus Christ came in the flesh.” Some teachers in John’s day said the Son only seemed to have a body. John says that denies the whole thing: the Word became flesh (2 John 1:7, John 1:14).
- “This is the deceiver and the Antichrist.” Antichrist in John’s letters is not only one figure at the end. It is any spirit that denies the Messiah came in the flesh (2 John 1:7, 1 John 4:3).

- “Watch yourselves, that we don’t lose the things which we have accomplished.” It is possible to work hard for years and let a deceiver walk off with it (2 John 1:8).
- “A full reward.” Boaz blessed Ruth: may a full reward be given you from Yahweh, under whose wings you have come to take refuge (2 John 1:8, Ruth 2:12).
- “Whoever transgresses” - literally goes ahead, runs on beyond. Some claimed to have advanced past the simple teaching. John says going beyond the teaching of the Messiah is going beyond God (2 John 1:9).
- “He who remains in the teaching, the same has both the Father and the Son.” You cannot have one without the other (2 John 1:9, John 14:9).
- “Don’t receive him into your house, and don’t welcome him.” The assemblies met in homes, and traveling teachers depended on hospitality. Taking in a false teacher meant giving him a platform and a meal ticket (2 John 1:10).
- This is not about refusing to speak to unbelievers or to people with questions. It is about not sponsoring someone whose mission is to deny that the Messiah came in the flesh (2 John 1:10-11).
- “He who welcomes him participates in his evil deeds.” Supporting a work makes you a partner in it (2 John 1:11, Psalm 1:1).
- “I don’t want to do so with paper and ink.” Papyrus and ink were the materials. Some things are better said in person (2 John 1:12).
- “To speak face to face” is literally mouth to mouth - what Yahweh said of Moses: with him I speak mouth to mouth, plainly (2 John 1:12, Numbers 12:8).
- “That our joy may be made full.” Joy made full is the same phrase the Lord used the night before the cross (2 John 1:12, John 15:11).

## Key Cross-References (WEB)

| Topic | References |
|---|---|
| His Faithfulness Endures Forever | 2 John 1:2 • Psalm 117:2 • Psalm 119:160 |
| I Will Walk in Your Truth | 2 John 1:4 • Psalm 86:11 • 3 John 1:4 |
| From the Beginning | 2 John 1:5 • Leviticus 19:18 • 1 John 2:7 |
| Love Him and Keep His Commandments | 2 John 1:6 • Deuteronomy 11:1 • Deuteronomy 10:12-13 |
| Deceivers Gone Out | 2 John 1:7 • Deuteronomy 13:1-3 • 1 John 4:1-3 |
| A Full Reward | 2 John 1:8 • Ruth 2:12 |
| The Counsel of the Wicked | 2 John 1:10 • Psalm 1:1 • Proverbs 13:20 |
| Mouth to Mouth | 2 John 1:12 • Numbers 12:8 • Exodus 33:11 |

## Messianic Connections

| Connection | References |
|---|---|
| Grace and Peace From Yahweh | 2 John 1:3 • Numbers 6:24-26 |
| What Is His Son's Name? | 2 John 1:3 • Proverbs 30:4 • Psalm 2:7 |
| Come in the Flesh | 2 John 1:7 • Isaiah 7:14 • Isaiah 9:6 |
| Both the Father and the Son | 2 John 1:9 • Psalm 2:12 • Isaiah 48:16 |
| Everlasting Joy | 2 John 1:12 • Psalm 16:11 • Isaiah 35:10 |

## For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - 2 John Commentary (David Guzik) - verse by verse through walking in the truth
- BibleProject - 1-3 John Overview - a short video on the three letters of John and the teachers they warn about
- Precept Austin - 2 John Commentary - verse by verse notes and word studies

## 2 John 1 - Opening Intro

Second John is the second shortest book in the Bible. Thirteen verses. It would have fit on a single sheet of papyrus.

And it is from the elder - almost certainly John the apostle, by now an old man - to the chosen lady and her children.

We do not know for sure if that is a real woman and her family, or a congregation he is calling the lady. At the end he says the children of your chosen sister greet you, which sounds a lot like one church greeting another.

And two words run through the whole letter. Truth. And love. John says truth five times in the first four verses. And he will not let you have one without the other.

He says: I rejoice greatly that I found some of your children walking in truth.

Some. Not all. And he does not pretend. He rejoices in the ones who are walking, and he lets the silence speak about the others.

And then: I am not writing you a new commandment. It is the one we had from the beginning - that we love one another.

And that goes all the way back to Leviticus 19. Love your neighbor as yourself.

And then John does something that the modern church really needs to hear. He defines love. This is love: that we walk according to His commandments.

Love is not a feeling that floats free of obedience. Love walks in the commandments. That is what Moses said too - love Yahweh your God, and keep His commandments always. John did not invent that. He is repeating it.

Then a warning. Many deceivers have gone out into the world. People who do not confess that Jesus the Messiah came in the flesh.

There were teachers in John's day who said the Son of God only looked like He had a body. That He did not really have flesh and blood. And John says: that is the spirit of antichrist. Because the whole thing hangs on the Word becoming flesh.

And notice they went out. They had been inside. False teaching does not usually come from outside the walls.

Watch yourselves, John says, so you do not lose what you have worked for. You can build something for years and let a deceiver walk away with it in an afternoon.

And then: whoever runs ahead - goes beyond the teaching of the Messiah - does not have God. Some of them thought they had advanced past the basics. John says: going past Him is going away from God.

And then the instruction that people get confused about. If somebody comes to you and does not bring this teaching, do not take him into your house.

Remember, the churches met in houses. And traveling teachers lived on hospitality. Taking one in meant giving him your living room, your congregation and your dinner table. John is not saying be rude to people with questions. He is saying do not sponsor somebody whose whole mission is to deny the Messiah came in the flesh. Because if you welcome him, you share in his work.

And then he just stops. I have a lot more to tell you, but I do not want to do it with paper and ink. I hope to come and talk face to face - mouth to mouth - so our joy can be full.

Mouth to mouth is how God said He spoke with Moses. Some things are too important for a letter.

Before we read - ask yourself whether you have been trying to have truth without love, or love without truth. John will not let you have either one alone.

## 2 John 1:1-13 (WEB)

**1** The elder, to the chosen lady and her children, whom I love in truth; and not I only, but also all those who know the truth;

**2** for the truth's sake, which remains in us, and it will be with us forever:[1]

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[1] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 117:2 • Psalm 119:160 - *Yahweh's faithfulness endures forever, and all your words are truth*

**3** Grace, mercy, and peace will be with us, from God the Father, and from the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of the Father, in truth and love.[2,3]

**4** I rejoice greatly that I have found some of your children walking in truth, even as we have been commanded by the Father.[4]

**5** Now I beg you, dear lady, not as though I wrote to you a new commandment, but that which we had from the beginning, that we love one another.[5]

**6** This is love, that we should walk according to his commandments. This is the commandment, even as you heard from the beginning, that you should walk in it.[6]

**7** For many deceivers have gone out into the world, those who don't confess that Jesus Christ came in the flesh. This is the deceiver and the Antichrist.[7,8]

**8** Watch yourselves, that we don't lose the things which we have accomplished, but that we receive a full reward.[9]

**9** Whoever transgresses and doesn't remain in the teaching of Christ, doesn't have God. He who remains in the teaching, the same has both the Father and the Son.[10]

**10** If anyone comes to you, and doesn't bring this teaching, don't receive him into your house, and don't welcome him,[11]

**11** for he who welcomes him participates in his evil deeds.

**12** Having many things to write to you, I don't want to do so with paper and ink, but I hope to come to you, and to speak face to face, that our joy may be made full.[12,13]

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[2] **Messianic Connection:** Numbers 6:24-26 - *Yahweh bless you and keep you, be gracious to you, and give you peace*

[3] **Messianic Connection:** Proverbs 30:4 • Psalm 2:7 - *what is his name, and what is his son's name, and you are my son*

[4] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 86:11 • 3 John 1:4 - *teach me your way and I will walk in your truth, and no greater joy than children walking in truth*

[5] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 19:18 • 1 John 2:7 - *love your neighbor as yourself, and an old commandment which you had from the beginning*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 11:1 • Deuteronomy 10:12-13 - *love Yahweh your God and keep his commandments always, to walk in all his ways and to love him*

[7] **Messianic Connection:** Isaiah 7:14 • Isaiah 9:6 - *the virgin will conceive and bear a son, Immanuel, and to us a child is born, Mighty God*

[8] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 13:1-3 • 1 John 4:1-3 - *do not listen to the prophet who leads after other gods, and test the spirits*

[9] **Cross-Reference:** Ruth 2:12 - *a full reward from Yahweh, under whose wings you have come to take refuge*

[10] **Messianic Connection:** Psalm 2:12 • Isaiah 48:16 - *homage given to the Son, and the Lord Yahweh has sent me, with his Spirit*

[11] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 1:1 • Proverbs 13:20 - *blessed is the man who doesn't walk in the counsel of the wicked, and a companion of fools suffers harm*

[12] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 12:8 • Exodus 33:11 - *with Moses I speak mouth to mouth, and face to face as a man speaks to his friend*

**13** The children of your chosen sister greet you. Amen.

[13] **Messianic Connection:** Psalm 16:11 • Isaiah 35:10 - *in your presence is fullness of joy, and everlasting joy on the heads of the ransomed*

## Major Themes in 2 John

- An old man who called himself only the elder
- Truth and love, never one without the other
- Truth that remains in us forever
- Grace, mercy and peace promised, not only wished
- Rejoicing in the children who are walking in truth
- A commandment from the beginning: love one another
- Love defined as walking in His commandments
- Deceivers who went out from within
- The Word who came in the flesh
- Watching so we do not lose what we worked for
- Running ahead of the teaching and leaving God behind
- Having both the Father and the Son
- A door kept shut to those who deny Him
- Some things better said face to face
- Joy made full

## Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May the truth remain in us and be with us forever.

May grace, mercy and peace be with us.

May our children be found walking in truth.

May we love one another, as we were commanded from the beginning.

May our love walk in His commandments.

May we confess the Messiah who came in the flesh.

May we watch ourselves and receive a full reward.

May we never run ahead of His teaching.

May we have both the Father and the Son.

May our homes never become a platform for deceit.

May we speak face to face where it matters most.

May our joy be made full.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.